GLASSHOUSE

NO AMITY IN AMETHI

The word is that **Rahul Gandhi** may contest the 2024 Lok Sabha poll once again from family bastion Amethi, despite the loss in 2019. The ground situation, though, doesn't seem conducive. Recently, Uttar Pradesh Congress chief Brijlal Khabri visited Amethi where, embarrassingly, the district president resigned midway through a meeting, alleging that the state high command and local leaders did not listen to him. Needless to say, Khabri's visit did not end well. What's ironic is that many in the Congress see the situation in Amethi as symptomatic of the 'conflict' in the state between the Rahul camp and that of his sister **Priyanka Gandhi-Vadra**, who is the AICC general secretary in charge of UP.



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE



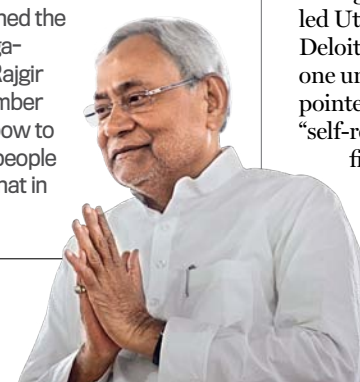
ANI

NON-STOP MODI

The ceaseless campaign for the Gujarat election in November is taking a toll on senior BJP leaders. Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel, often perceived to be a mute voice in party affairs, has now, literally, lost his voice. Union home minister Amit Shah had to skip a public rally in Vadodara over the weekend due to bad health resulting from exertion. Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** seems to be the only exception. BJP functionaries wonder how the PM, who is 72, keeps his gruelling schedule in the state. It's called the tireless will to win.

In Ganga's Name

In 2014, when Narendra Modi decided to contest the Lok Sabha polls from Varanasi, he famously quipped: "*Mujhe toh Ma Ganga ne bulaya hai* (Mother Ganga has called me)." With the 2024 general election less than two years away, it's the turn of Bihar chief minister **Nitish Kumar** to invoke the holy river. Projecting him as an alternative to Modi, his supporters cheered him on with slogans like "*Hamara PM kaisa ho, Nitish ji ke jaisa ho* (What should our PM be like, just like Nitish)" when the chief minister launched the Har Ghar Gangajal scheme in Rajgir town on November 27. Will Nitish bow to the will of the people and throw his hat in the ring?



HARDIK CHHABRA



Mark Time?

Telugu Desam Party (TDP) general secretary **N. Lokesh** is planning a *padayatra* next year, starting January 27, from Kuppam—his father and party supremo N. Chandrababu Naidu's constituency—to Itchapuram in the northeast corner of coastal Andhra Pradesh. The *padayatra* has worked well as a path to power in Andhra, most notably for CM Y.S. Jagan Mohan Reddy of the Yuvajana Shramika Rythu Congress (YSRC). But the TDP says this is by way of poll preparations, in case Jagan decides to advance the dates for the assembly polls (the state is due in 2024 along with the general election). Naidu Jr has tried to rope in youth leaders for the march, notably heirs of TDP veterans, but the response has been lukewarm so far.

FOREIGN HAND



Uttarakhand is the latest BJP-ruled state to seek the help of a global consulting firm to guide its growth trajectory. Chief Minister **Pushkar Singh Dhami** has zeroed in on McKinsey to prepare a blueprint for doubling its Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) in the next five years. The party's paterfamilias, the RSS, may baulk, but it seems that is the road ahead. Earlier in August, Yogi Adityanath-led Uttar Pradesh appointed Deloitte to do a similar job. As one unimpressed RSS ideologue pointed out drily, one needs to be "self-reliant" in developing ideas first before attempting to make the economies "self-reliant".

Kaushik Deka with Prashant Srivastava, Jumana Shah, Amitabh Srivastava, Amarnath K. Menon and Anilesh S. Mahajan